outcomes on issues in which they are weak. Similarly, unequal distribution of power resources in trade shipping or oil result in variations in patterns of outcomes of political bargaining, creating political processes which differ from one set of issues to another.[21]

Management of interdependent relations may involve construction of rules and associated institutions and international organizations to govern the interactions in the issue areas. These definitely would give rise to international regimes and the scope of activity of the international organizations will increase in this interdependent world. In the absence of superordinate central authority, these rules are voluntarily established by states to provide some degree of order in international relations. Voluntarism, thus, becomes central to this mode of thought.[22]

Overall, increased transnational and trans-governmental relations blur the distinction between national and international politics and create political processes in which results cannot be predicted by assuming the dominance of the states.

The basic assumptions of the pluralist models are:

1. Acknowledgement of the presence of non-state actors.
2. Non-military and non-security issues such as population, pollution, distribution of food, depletion of natural resources, dependency and outer space are the priority areas.
3. An increase of interdependence—trade, technology transfer, investment, travel migration, student exchanges and other interactions have risen manifold.
4. War is no longer a major option for foreign policy decision-makers, and the more powerful a nation is, the less viable the war becomes. As one pointed out: “We are moving to an era dominated by economic power—an era in which war between major states may virtually disappear”.[21]

Criticisms

The first and foremost shortcoming of the pluralist theory is that islands of theory are constructed rather than building such general theory as propounded by realists. Some concentrate on the